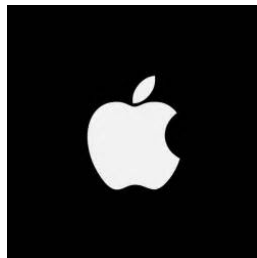




Communication Tools for the
Inclusive Higher Education
Community:
We Have to Work Together!

 **ThinkCollege**
NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER



The TPSID National Coordinating Center at Think College is a project of the
Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston.
The Center is funded by the Office of Postsecondary Education Grant #P407B100002.





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AUCD 2017
LIFT YOUR
VOICE!
 NOVEMBER 5-8
 WASHINGTON, DC

- Exemplary services for children, adults, and families
- Academic training
- Basic and applied research
- Training and technical assistance to schools, communities, and all levels of government
- Policy advocacy
- Program evaluation
- ***Dissemination of best practices and new information***



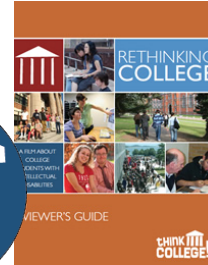
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So how do we do that?

- Print advertising,
- Billboards,
- Airplane banner,
- Social media,
- Documentary film,
- Clothing,
- Tchotchkes,
- Social media,
- **and Publications!**



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Some of our publications... your name could be here!

Think College FAST FACTS
Access to the Disability Supports Office by Students with Intellectual Disability in TPSID Programs
By Clare Papay, Frank A. Smith, & Meg Grigal
ISSUE NO. 13, 2017

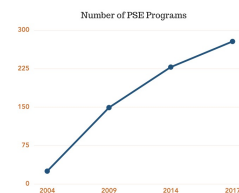
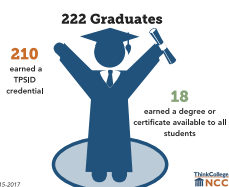
THINK COLLEGE STORIES
Continued Opportunities for Inclusion
Advancing Success Toward Education and Employment (ASTEP)
By Holly Schmitt and Joe McNeil, both of whom have intellectual disabilities. One moment of inclusion was especially meaningful: attending the regular college commencement ceremony. ASTEP has been supporting students with intellectual disabilities (ID) since 2011, and spring 2017 was the first year that students with ID were able to participate in the ceremony.

INSIGHT
Communicating with Your Student's College under FERPA's National Postsecondary Education Support and Privacy Act (FERPA)
ISSUE NO. 21, 2017

HOW TO ThinkCollege
Conducting a College Search: Questions to Ask College Professionals
by Cate Weil
Issue No. 1, 2017

STUDENTS' RIGHTS AT AGE 18
HOW DOES FERPA DEFINE "PARENT"?
The term "parent" is defined in FERPA as "including natural parents, a guardian or an individual acting as a parent in the absence of a parent or a guardian." There are some unique factors involved when the parent is the legal guardian of an adult college student with a disability in the absence of any other legal guardian.

What news do you want to share: Great data? Positive student outcomes? An innovative process? Effective partnerships?



DISCOVERY OPTIONS

What are ways to collect information about someone who needs a job?

Check off the different ways in which you chose to gain information about a jobseeker, and then describe the process you went through after each option.

☐ One-on-one interview with the jobseeker. This process works best with people who are verbal, enjoy talking about themselves, and can clearly express thoughts. This process can also be used with someone who is nonverbal if picture cues or effective communication devices are available. Having a key stakeholder who understands the substance of the or four nonverbal cues and reactions may be helpful to have participate.

☐ Observe in a group or classroom. This process is helpful to see how someone interacts with other people and authority figures, how they or he behaves differently. Focus on traits, such as humor and confidence, and contribute to the class or group as a whole. In terms of employment, this gives you insight into learning style, social behavior, and information gathering which will tell you what types of work environments might be most suitable. How he or she could learn a new task on the job, and how he or she might interact with a supervisor.

☐ The review. This method of gaining information allows you to see a person's history, understand medical needs, review behavior plans, see general testing scores, etc. This information alone is good background, but not all that useful in telling someone to an employer?



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You just need to decide what kind of work you want to write:

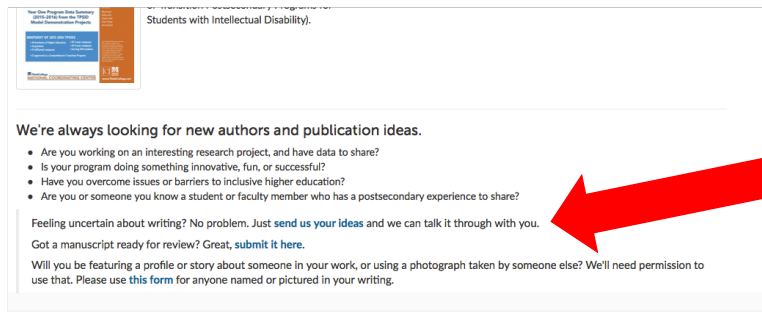
- **Insight Brief:** Detailed discussion of research, policy or practice related to inclusive higher education; manuscript may be 2,000-3,000 words
- **Fast Facts:** Focused discussion of a big idea, simplified for target audience; manuscript length should be 900-1,200 words
- **How To Think College:** Practical information for families, educators, practitioners to use right away; manuscript length will vary
- **Think College Stories:** Authored by students with ID, these stories focus on college-related experiences; manuscript length should be 800-1,000 words



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And then you can easily submit an idea
(or manuscript if it's ready!) right here:
<https://thinkcollege.net/resources/think-college-publications>



Students with Intellectual Disability.

We're always looking for new authors and publication ideas.

- Are you working on an interesting research project, and have data to share?
- Is your program doing something innovative, fun, or successful?
- Have you overcome issues or barriers to inclusive higher education?
- Are you or someone you know a student or faculty member who has a postsecondary experience to share?

Feeling uncertain about writing? No problem. Just [send us your ideas](#) and we can talk it through with you.

Got a manuscript ready for review? Great, [submit it here](#).

Will you be featuring a profile or story about someone in your work, or using a photograph taken by someone else? We'll need permission to use that. Please use [this form](#) for anyone named or pictured in your writing.



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What we've discussed so far:

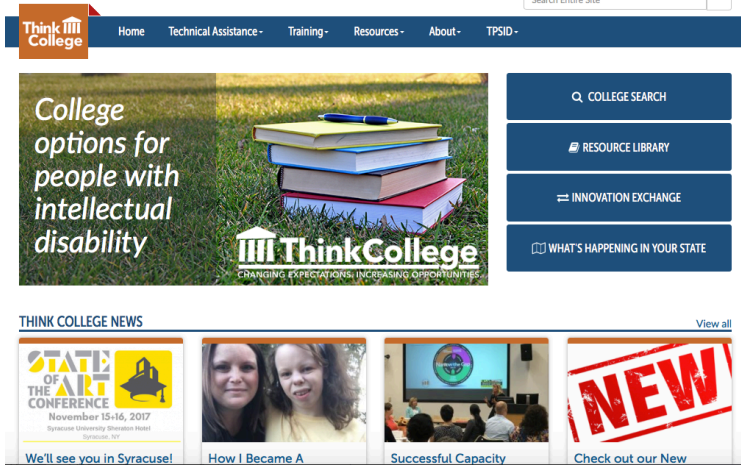
- We have a message we want to share: Students with intellectual disability are going to college. And working. And enjoying quality lives doing things they choose to do.
- Within our network (and beyond), we know people who are doing great work that we want to talk about and share.
- We join together to develop this message and make it pretty and publish it. Then what?
- And by now you should realize that you've got an excellent partner in Think College. So after you write that publication, let's look at all the ways we can get the word out....



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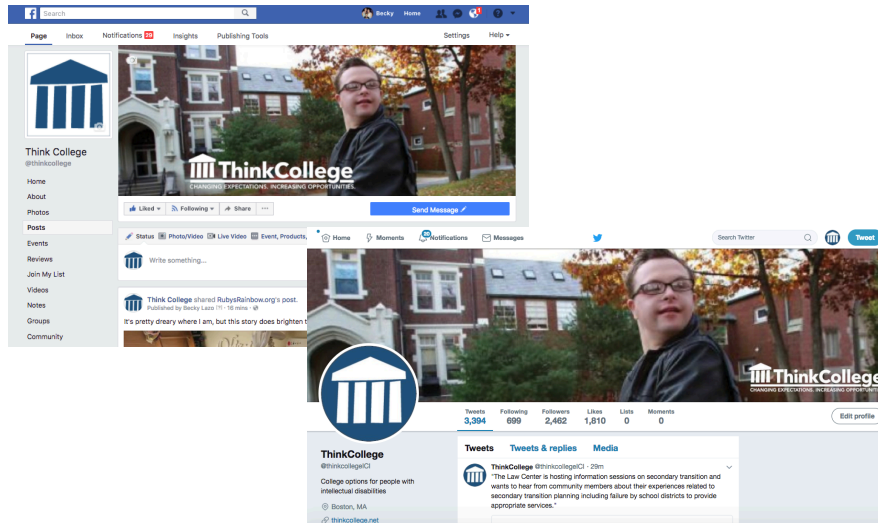
Newly designed Think College website



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Share and connect on social media



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Join us for webinars, research summits, and affinity group meetings, where you'll hear the latest on relevant topics. (We may even ask you to present!)

[Home](#) / [Training](#) / Events and Webinars: Upcoming

Events and Webinars: Upcoming

Think College provides training that disseminates research and promising practices related to postsecondary education for students with intellectual disability, including webinars, conference presentations, capacity-building institutes and research summits.

Note: All times below are U.S. Eastern time.

UPCOMING EVENTS PAST EVENTS

EVENT CATEGORIES

- Any -

Title	Date	Location	Event Category
State of the Art Conference on PSE for Students with ID	Nov 15, 2017 to Nov 16, 2017	Syracuse, NY	External Conference
Student Leadership Conference at State of the Art	Nov 15, 2017 to Nov 16, 2017	Syracuse, NY	External Conference
Public Policy Affinity Group meeting	Nov 30, 2017 2:00 PM to 3:00 PM	Zoom	Policy Affinity Group Meeting
Fall 2017 Research Summit	Dec 7, 2017 2:00 PM to 3:30 PM	Zoom	Research Summit
#IncludemeInCollege: How One Girl's Dream of College Changed Others' Ways of Thinking	Dec 12, 2017 4:00 PM to 5:00 PM	Zoom webinar	Think College Webinar



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What is a research summit?

**Next Research Summit is December 7 at 2pm;
registration now open on our website!**

Think College Research summits feature invited presenters around a certain topic related to postsecondary education for students with ID.

They are meant to

- inform the research community,
- support networking,
- enhance knowledge of the impact of inclusive higher education, and
- identify areas of need for future research.



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So, what's an affinity group?

LEARN • SHARE • CONNECT

THINK COLLEGE AFFINITY GROUPS

***An affinity group is a group of people who come together based on areas of common interest and need.**

Think College hosts affinity groups on topics related to higher education for students with intellectual disability. Meetings are primarily online, and new members are always welcome! Affinity groups offer the opportunity for in-depth focus on a single topic in collaboration with others. Each group gives members a forum for exchanging knowledge, and for problem-solving based on people's real experiences. These groups can break down networking, communication, and organizational barriers, and extend each member's range of contacts and knowledge.

Current Affinity Groups

- Research on Higher Education for Students with Intellectual Disability
- Public Policy and Higher Education for Students with Intellectual Disability
- Vocational Rehabilitation and Inclusive Higher Education

To join the research affinity group, fill out this form. Clare Papay, facilitator of this group, will be in touch.
 To join the policy affinity group, fill out this form. Denise Rozell, facilitator of this group, will be in touch.
 To join the vocational rehabilitation affinity group, fill out this form. Russell Thelin, facilitator of this group, will be in touch.



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It's great to really be able to connect with like-minded people and social media can only get you so far...



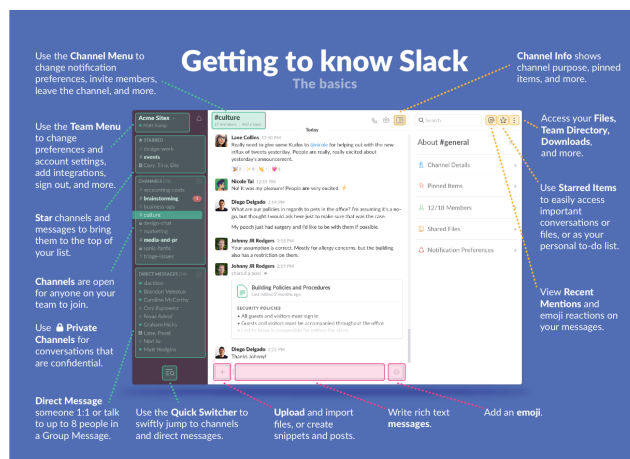
- So we use something called Slack. Slack is an online messaging and information sharing platform. It allows groups of people to communicate with each other easily, share information, ask questions, and get answers.
- The conversations held in Slack are searchable, so if you find yourself wondering who else has asked about academic assessment or you can't remember what Susanna Miller-Raines said about partnering with vocational rehabilitation, you can search for any of those terms and find the information you need.



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Slack diagram of best features



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My overview of best Slack features:

- **Portability:** you can use Slack via their website or using an app on your desktop or any mobile device.
- **Customizability:** you can easily set up your personal preferences in Slack. Do you only want to be notified when Think College staff posts? Do you want to know when someone is talking about activity in NY? Do you want the app to automatically turn on and off based on your typical work day?
- **Integration with other apps:** Zoom, Google, Salesforce, GitHub, Simple Poll, Dropbox, Twitter, and MANY more.
- **It's a smart app:** after you use Slack for awhile, it makes recommendations for channels you may want to join, terms you like to search, and more.
- **If you (and your colleagues and friends) get on board, you have an instant, almost-always-available network of people to turn to for answers, information, and support!**



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Anyone like to see a brief demo?

- <https://thinkcollege.slack.com/messages/COW8PLCBY/files/>



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Last but definitely not least...
the Family Hub.



NOT the new refrigerator, but a destination on the Think College website where families can head to and comfortably browse the resources on our website. We will provide some helpful guidance so families can easily find what they're looking for on our website. And the goal is to begin a network for families to connect with one another, as well.



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TEAMWORK

Teamwork makes the dream work.

“Coming together is a beginning, keeping together is progress, staying together is success.” – Henry Ford

“Talent wins games, but teamwork and intelligence wins championships.” – Michael Jordan

Simply stated: less me and more we.

“I can do things you cannot, you can do things I cannot; together we can do great things.”

– Mother Teresa



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One of my favorites, though...



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Your to do list:

- ✓Join Slack!
- ✓Follow us on Facebook and Twitter and check out our website.
- ✓Get in touch with us: we want to know if you have suggestions for our website, or news and events to share.
- ✓Consider writing for us: we have multiple options to develop your ideas and staff to provide feedback.
- ✓Sign up for our mailing list and attend our events.



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THANK YOU!!

- Contact me: Rebecca Lazo, rebecca.lazo@umb.edu
- Contact our Technical Assistance desk, ThinkCollegeTA@gmail.com

- Join Slack:



<https://thinkcollege.net/technical-assistance/join-conversation>

- Follow us on social media:

<https://www.facebook.com/thinkcollege/>

<https://twitter.com/thinkcollegelCI>



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